Creating Gutenberg Blocks with Advanced Custom Fields (ACF)

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Learn how to enhance your WordPress site with custom Gutenberg blocks using the Advanced Custom Fields plugin. In this guide, we'll cover the basics, from understanding Gutenberg blocks to building customized solutions with ACF.

What is Gutenberg?

Introduced in WordPress version 5.0 in 2018, the **Gutenberg editor** revolutionized content creation by offering a block-based experience. Initially seen as a "fancier" way to publish content, it has evolved into a versatile tool for building modular content and even full-site editing. This modular approach allows

developers to create highly flexible and customized website solutions.

Understanding Gutenberg Blocks

Gutenberg blocks are modules that serve various purposes, from basic text editors to more complex elements like sliders and WooCommerce product displays. For users, these blocks are the building blocks of their website's content layout. But for developers, these blocks are React-based components that require a good understanding of JavaScript for creation and customization.

However, not every developer is comfortable with React. If you're looking for a way to create more personalized solutions without diving deep into React, the ACF plugin is your answer.

https://devblondie.com/wp-content/uploads/2023/06/blocks.gif

At 42Works, we often utilize ACF to craft custom blocks that meet our client's unique requirements, allowing them to maintain full control over their content without the need for advanced coding skills.

Why Use Advanced Custom Fields (ACF) with Gutenberg?

If you need more flexibility with Gutenberg blocks but lack the expertise in React, the **Advanced Custom Fields (ACF)** plugin is the solution. With ACF, you can create custom Gutenberg blocks using PHP, giving you full control over block customization without requiring extensive JavaScript knowledge.

What is Advanced Custom Fields (ACF)?

ACF is a freemium WordPress

plugin that allows you to add custom fields to pages, posts, menus, and Gutenberg blocks, transforming WordPress into a fully customizable CMS.**42Works** leverages the power of ACF to build customized WordPress solutions that fit your unique requirements. We create tailored blocks that enhance your website's functionality and offer a seamless user experience.

How to Create Custom Fields with ACF

1. **Install ACF Plugin**: Start by installing the ACF plugin. Even the free version offers a robust set of features.

https://devblondie.com/wp-content/uploads/2023/06/acf.gif

2. **Create a Custom Field**: Go to the ACF menu, select "Create new field group," and choose your desired field type (text, number, link, image, etc.).

https://devblondie.com/wp-

content/uploads/2023/06/acf-new-fields-2.gif

3. **Specify Field Appearance**: You can assign these fields to specific post types, pages, or Gutenberg blocks.

Link Fields to Elements: The get_field() function associates your custom fields with front-end elements.

```
<h2 class="blue-text txt-size-20"> <?php get_field('heading_text'); ?> </h2>
```

Registering a New Gutenberg Block with ACF

To register a new block using ACF, you'll need the Pro version of the plugin. Here's a step-by-step guide:

1. **Use acf_register_block_type() Function**: Add this function in your theme's functions.php file to initialize your new block.

2. **Define Block Attributes**: Include attributes like the block's name, title, description, render

template, category, icon, and more.

Here's an example:

php

```
add_action('acf/init', 'my_acf_blocks_init');

function my_acf_blocks_init() {

    if( function_exists('acf_register_block_type') ) {

        acf_register_block_type(array(

            'name'            => 'testimonial',

            'title'           => __('Testimonial'),

            'description'     => __('A custom testimonial block.'),

            'render_template'  => 'template-parts/blocks/testimonial/testimonial.php',

            'category'        => 'formatting',
```

```
        'icon'          => 'book-alt',
    ));
  }
}
```

Creating a Template for the New Block

Once your block is registered, create a template file (testimonial.php) in a designated folder (blocks/testimonial/). This file will contain the block's HTML structure, which can later be enhanced using dynamic ACF fields.

For example:

php

Copy code

```
<div class="testimonial-wrapper">
  <h4><?= get_field('heading'); ?>
</h4>
  <p><?= get_field('main_text'); ?>
</p>
```

```
<p><?= get_field('testimonial_author'); ?></p>

</div>
```

Conclusion

With **Gutenberg** and **Advanced Custom Fields (ACF)**, you can achieve unparalleled customization in WordPress, making it possible to create dynamic and personalized content blocks. At **42Works**, we specialize in leveraging these tools to build unique WordPress experiences tailored to your brand's needs.Ready to take your WordPress site to the next level? **Contact us today** to discover how our expertise in custom Gutenberg block development can enhance your website's functionality and user experience!

FAQ

1. What is Gutenberg in WordPress?

Gutenberg is the block editor in

WordPress that allows you to create content using a block-based interface. It replaces the classic editor and offers a more flexible way to design pages and posts.

2. What is Advanced Custom Fields (ACF)?

Advanced Custom Fields (ACF) is a powerful WordPress plugin that allows you to add custom fields to your posts, pages, and other content types. It's widely used for creating custom blocks in Gutenberg.

3. How do I create a custom Gutenberg block with ACF?

To create a custom Gutenberg block with ACF, you need to install and activate ACF Pro, register the block using ACF's block registration function, and then define your block's fields and output using PHP.

4. Do I need coding knowledge to use ACF with Gutenberg?

While basic knowledge of PHP is

recommended, ACF simplifies the process of creating custom blocks. ACF provides a user-friendly interface, but some coding may be required for advanced customization.

5. Can I use ACF to customize existing Gutenberg blocks?
Yes, ACF can be used to extend and customize existing Gutenberg blocks by adding additional fields or modifying block behavior to better suit your needs.

6. What are the advantages of using ACF for Gutenberg blocks?
ACF allows you to create highly customized blocks without needing to write extensive JavaScript code. It's flexible, integrates seamlessly with WordPress, and provides an easy way to manage custom fields

7. Is ACF Pro required to create Gutenberg blocks?
Yes, ACF Pro is required for block creation as it includes the ACF Blocks feature, which is not available in the free version of ACF.

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Founder and CEO

Anmol Rajdev, Founder & CEO of 42works, leads a team of 80+ experts in web and mobile development. Anmol is a technical architect powerhouse with 500+ successful projects under his belt,

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